

Security Checklist

Small-business security basics. Tick each item after confirming it is in place.

Protect accounts

☐ **Use unique passwords**

Keep long, unique passwords in a password manager.

☐ **Turn on multifactor authentication**

Start with email, banking, file storage and administrator accounts.

☐ **Prefer phishing-resistant sign-in**

Use passkeys or security keys where your services support them.

☐ **Review who can access systems**

Give each person their own login and only the access needed.

Protect devices and information

☐ **Keep software current**

Enable automatic updates for operating systems, browsers and business apps.

☐ **Lock and encrypt devices**

Use screen locks and full-disk encryption on business devices.

☐ **Separate guest Wi-Fi**

Use a separate guest network and secure the business network.

☐ **Verify payment-change requests**

Confirm new bank details through a known phone number, not a reply.

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Backups, recovery and a repeatable review routine.

Back up and prepare

☐ **Keep separate backups**

Back up important files. Keep a copy offline or protected from account compromise.

☐ **Test restoring files**

Restore a sample file so you know the backup works.

☐ **Keep recovery details secure**

Store recovery codes separately from the account they recover.

☐ **Choose a response contact**

Decide who to call if a device, account or customer information is compromised.

Review regularly

☐ **Remove old access**

Disable accounts and shared access when a person or vendor leaves.

☐ **Keep only needed information**

Limit collection, sharing and retention of customer information.

☐ **Practice spotting phishing**

Review suspicious links, attachments and unexpected requests with staff.

☐ **Recheck the essentials**

Review access, updates and backups after changes and on a regular schedule.

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Further guidance: FTC Cybersecurity for Small Business; CISA MFA and ransomware guides.

ftc.gov/business-guidance/small-businesses/cybersecurity

cisa.gov/stopransomware/ransomware-guide | Reviewed October 5, 2026